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But what a mercy of God to be, the second time inside as many months, received back a "prodigal" on the simple obedience - the coveted boon itself - of again putting on the holy Habit of your Order! Where in all history is there another such example? It surely speaks more than any works, for poor, dear Mother General's confidence in her wavering daughter. Ah! To me it looks as though Jesus Himself were someway behind Rev. Mother on that occasion, - as indeed He does seem to be someway coaching everything that tends to smoothe off and, notwithstanding her many infidelities, to facilitate the return of His, sadly inconstant, Constance. Still, the enemy of souls will ask - and the destroyer of the souls' peace - "If..." and "Why"... and will dare to intimate that there is something wrong - something other than mercy and wisdom and power and love in God. ... concerning His adjustments of our individual cases. Ah! These "Ifs and Whys"! Do they not sound like the wily philosophy of Grand-Mother Eve's garden adviser? ... Yes, it is disappointing to nature, to be deprived of a chance for self-justification. ... No doubt that is because of our corrupt nature's want of realization that in the science of the saints, and in the sight of all Heaven, self justification before creatures, is never a victory for the Christian soul. Ah! When we behold the astonishment of the Roman Governor and his whole court - Pilate before Jesus divinely silent. -What a contrast to our noisy self justification!

Sad to say, I feel myself to have been many times a "past-master" at that kind of worldly cleverness. Just that kind of cleverness is still one of Fr. Solanus' unhappy weaknesses. Hence, another instance of mercifully sparing from embarrassment in the sight of Heaven a wavering daughter, -- an inconstant spouse - so solicitously smoothing embarrassments away, before the Guardian Angels and all the triumphant Church and Heavenly Court, - really preventing some one from still further making a F. of herself.

Ah! Dear Sister: you had cause for wondering at Rev. Mother's not seeing you other than in your holy habit; but was it not - should it not have been wonder at Mother's overwhelming gentleness and forethought? Rather, was it not Jesus again smoothing off difficulties and embarrassments?